

Lovely · Employee Handbook

Welcome to Lovely

Lovely is a product design studio. This handbook describes how we work together, what we expect of each other, and the policies that keep the studio running smoothly. It applies to every employee, contractor, and intern.

If something here is unclear, ask your manager. This document is reviewed twice a year and updated as our practices change.

Returns

Clients may send back any deliverable within 30 days of final handover if it does not match the agreed specification. The studio issues the money back in full, to the original payment method, within 10 business days of the request being approved.

After 30 days we offer studio credit rather than money back. Credit does not expire and may be applied to any future engagement.

Work that has been published, printed, or shipped to the client's own customers cannot be sent back. In those cases we offer a revision round at no cost instead.

Requests are approved by the account lead. If a client disputes a decision, it is escalated to the studio director, whose decision is final.

Leave and Time Off

Every employee receives 25 days of paid annual leave per calendar year, in addition to public holidays. Leave does not roll over into the following year, so plan accordingly.

Request leave at least two weeks in advance through the studio calendar. Requests longer than five consecutive days need manager approval. During a client launch week, leave is granted only in exceptional circumstances.

Sick leave is uncapped and untracked. We trust people to rest when they are unwell and to tell their manager the same day if they cannot work.

Unpaid sabbatical of up to three months is available after four years of continuous service, subject to director approval.

Expenses and Reimbursement

Submit expenses within 45 days of the purchase date. Anything submitted later is not reimbursed except with director approval.

Receipts are required for every claim over 500 rupees. Photographs of paper receipts are acceptable. Claims are paid with the next monthly payroll run.

Client travel is reimbursed at cost: standard-class rail, economy flights, and mid-range hotels. Taxis are reimbursed when public transport is impractical or unsafe.

Software subscriptions under 2000 rupees per month can be approved by your manager. Anything

above that needs director sign-off before purchase, not after.

Security and Devices

Every studio laptop is issued with full-disk encryption enabled and must not be disabled. Use the studio password manager for all work credentials; never reuse a personal password for a work account.

Two-factor authentication is mandatory on every account that supports it, including email, source control, and the design tools.

A studio laptop is replaced on a fixed cycle and any device that is lost or stolen must be reported to the studio director on the same day so that it can be wiped remotely before a replacement is issued from the spare pool, which normally takes two working days.

Client files are stored only in the studio drive. Do not copy client work to personal cloud storage, personal email, or an unencrypted USB drive.

Onboarding

New joiners are paired with an onboarding buddy for their first month. The buddy is not their manager; the point is to have someone to ask the questions that feel too small to raise elsewhere.

The first week is deliberately light on client work: accounts and access on day one, a studio tools walkthrough on day two, and shadowing a live project for the rest of the week.

A formal check-in happens at 30, 60, and 90 days. Probation ends at 90 days with a written confirmation.

Every new joiner is issued a laptop, a monitor, and a desk chair. Hardware requests beyond that are made through your manager and reviewed at the start of each quarter.

Working Hours and Remote Work

Core hours are 11:00 to 16:00. Outside those hours you are free to arrange your day as suits you, provided your commitments to the team and to clients are met.

The studio operates on a hybrid pattern: two days in the studio and three days remote is the default. Teams may agree a different split if every member of the team consents.

Fully remote arrangements are possible for roles that do not require regular in-person collaboration, and are agreed in writing with the studio director before they begin.

If you work from a different timezone for more than two weeks, tell your manager in advance so that meetings can be scheduled sensibly.

Pay and Progression

Salaries are reviewed once a year, in April. Reviews consider the market rate for the role, the scope of work you are handling, and the feedback gathered during the year.

Payday is the last working day of each month. Payslips are issued through the payroll portal two days before payday.

Promotion is not tied to the annual review. A promotion case can be raised at any point in the year by you or by your manager, and is decided by the director together with two senior peers.

There is no individual performance bonus. When the studio has a strong year, a single profit share is distributed equally to everyone who has been employed for at least six months.

Feedback and Reviews

Every person has a one-to-one with their manager every two weeks. It is the employee's meeting: they set the agenda and the manager listens more than they speak.

Written feedback is gathered twice a year from the people you work with most closely. It is shared with you in full, with names attached, because anonymous feedback tends to be less useful and less kind.

Concerns about conduct are raised with your manager, or with the studio director if your manager is the subject of the concern. Every concern is acknowledged within two working days.

Client Communication

One person owns the relationship with each client: the account lead. All commitments about scope, timing, or price come from them, so that a client never receives two different answers.

Never promise a date in a live conversation. Take the request away, check it against the plan, and confirm in writing the same day.

Written updates go out every Friday for every active engagement, even the quiet ones. A short update on a week where nothing changed is more reassuring than silence.

Bad news is delivered early and directly. A slipped deadline raised two weeks ahead is a scheduling problem; the same slip raised on the day is a trust problem.

Confidentiality and Intellectual Property

Client work is confidential indefinitely, including after the engagement ends and after you leave the studio.

Work produced for a client belongs to that client on final payment. Tools, libraries, and internal components the studio builds along the way remain the property of the studio.

Adding a project to your personal portfolio requires the client's written permission. The account lead will request it on your behalf; do not approach the client directly.

Do not discuss an unannounced client project in public, including on social media and at industry events, until the client has announced it themselves.

Support Escalation and Response Times

Client issues are raised in the shared support channel and triaged by the account lead each morning.

A blocking issue, meaning the client cannot use the delivered work at all, is acknowledged within 2 hours and worked continuously until resolved.

A major issue, meaning a significant feature is broken but a workaround exists, is acknowledged within 1 business day and resolved within 5 business days.

A minor issue, such as a cosmetic defect or a copy change, is acknowledged within 2 business days and batched into the next scheduled revision round.

If an issue is not resolved within its target, the account lead notifies the client directly with a revised estimate rather than letting the deadline pass silently.